

Getting Past the Gatekeeper

One Wealth Map RIA outreach

Each situation has a goal, a sample response and the reason behind it. Use the samples as a guide, then adjust them to your own style.

Know your goal

With a gatekeeper: **get connected**. With the owner: **book the meeting**.

Leave with something

Try to end each call with a **transfer**, a **callback time**, a **direct line**, or an **email**.

Keep it short

Your answer to a gatekeeper should be one or two sentences. Long answers sound like a sales call.

START HERE

Think of the gatekeeper as a building guard

A guard lets people in when they give a name and a clear reason. When someone starts explaining products, the guard usually stops them at the lobby. Gatekeepers work the same way.

A simple pattern to follow:



Why end with a question: asking "Are they available now?" keeps the call moving toward your goal. It gives the gatekeeper something simple to answer.

WORDS

Words that help, words to avoid

These help

- **"Business matter"** is clear and true
- **"On behalf of our founder"** explains who the call is from
- **The owner's first name** shows you did your research
- **"Please"** and **"thank you"** keep it respectful
- **"Is a better time later today?"** gives you a next step

Avoid these

- **"Opportunity"** or **"potential"** sound like a sales call
- **"Offer," "services," "AI," "grow faster"** also sound like a sales call
- **A long company description** (location, type of firm) when they didn't ask
- **"Sorry to bother you"** at the start makes the call sound unimportant
- **Trailing off** mid-sentence makes it harder to finish your point

Always be honest

Be confident, but **only say what's true**. Don't say it's a follow-up call if it isn't. Don't say the owner or founder asked for the call unless that's confirmed. Don't pretend to know the owner. These calls can be recorded, and the firms we call are regulated. Honesty protects you, the client and One Wealth Map.

Playbook v2 reminders

Before you dial: check GHL and the lead source. Know if it's a firm owner or an individual advisor, and their first name.

Never say to a gatekeeper: anything about selling, buying, merging or recruiting, any numbers, or who else we're talking to. Owner conversations are confidential.

A Screening questions

The gatekeeper is checking who you are and why you're calling.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
1	"What's this regarding?"	One short, true reason. Then ask for the owner again.	Like telling a guard "I'm here to see Mr. Reyes." You don't show them your presentation. Short answers sound clear and professional.
Sample: "It's regarding a business matter for [Owner]. Are they available now?"			
2	"Is this a sales call?"	Answer honestly: no. Then redirect to being connected.	Like a guard asking "Delivery?" "No" alone can sound unclear. "No, it's a business matter" sounds like a visitor.
Sample: "No, it isn't. It's a business matter for [Owner], on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. Could you connect me, please?"			
3	"Where are you calling from?"	Say the company name only. Add more only if they ask more.	Like a name tag. It says who you are. Nobody reads a brochure at the front desk.
Sample: "One Wealth Map. Is [Owner] available, please?"			
4	"Do you have an appointment?"	Say no honestly, then redirect to availability.	Like walking up without a reservation. Restaurants still seat you if you ask confidently: "No reservation, is a table free now?"
Sample: "No, I don't. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. Is [Owner] available now?"			

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
5	"Does the owner know you?"	Be open that this is the first time they'll connect. Then redirect to availability.	Like a new neighbor knocking. You don't pretend to be a relative. Being honest keeps their trust.
Sample: "This would be our first conversation. I'm calling on behalf of our founder about a business matter. Is [Owner] available?"			
6	"How did you get this number?"	Briefly share the real source, without overexplaining.	Like a shop asked how it got your address. A clear answer calms people. Avoiding the question can feel suspicious.
Sample: "Our research team came across your firm. Is [Owner] available now?"			
7	"Can I tell them what it's about?"	Give a short, credible reason they can pass on to the owner. Then redirect to availability.	Like a sealed letter. The secretary delivers it but doesn't open it. "Business matter" says important and private.
Sample: "Sure. Please let [Owner] know it's [Name] from One Wealth Map, calling on behalf of our founder about a business matter. Are they free now, or when should I call back?"			
8	They keep asking for more details.	Give enough context to sound legitimate and important, without the full pitch. Then redirect.	Like a movie trailer. Enough to show it's worth it. The full story is for the owner.
Sample: "We're a financial advisory firm, and it's regarding a business discussion about [Owner]'s practice. Is [Owner] available?"			

B Owner not available

When the owner is busy, find out the best time to call back.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
9	"They're with a client / in a meeting."	Get a specific callback time. Log it in GHL.	Like a doctor in surgery. You ask the nurse what time they'll be out. "Later" isn't a time.
Sample: "No problem. What time do they usually finish? Would 3 or 4 PM work better?"			
10	"They're out this week."	Find the day they're back.	Like a store closed for the holidays. You check the reopening date instead of guessing.
Sample: "Thanks for letting me know. What day are they back? I'll call then."			
11	"They're busy all day, every day."	Find a gap: early or late.	Like catching a busy professor. Not during class. Before the first or after the last.
Sample: "Understood. Are they usually free early in the morning or near the end of the day?"			

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
12	"Everything goes through me."	Make the gatekeeper your partner.	Like a barangay hall. Follow their process and the secretary helps you. Fight it, and nothing moves.
Sample: "Thank you, I appreciate your help. What's the best way to get a business matter to [Owner]?"			

C Brush-offs

Say yes to their request, then ask for one more detail.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
13	"If they're interested, they'll call you back."	Ask for the best time to call instead.	Like "we'll text you" after a job interview. You may not hear back. Setting the next step yourself helps.
Sample: "I understand. To save everyone time, when is the best time for me to call back?"			
14	"Send an email."	Say yes, then ask for a direct email or a time.	Like "leave it at the front desk." It may sit in a pile. A direct address gives it a real chance.
Sample: "Happy to. What's [Owner]'s direct email, so it reaches them directly?"			
15	"Send it to info@."	Avoid the general inbox.	Like a box marked "General." It might never get opened.
Sample: "Sure. Is there a direct email for [Owner]? If not, when is a good time to call back?"			
16	"Leave a message."	Leave it short, and set your own follow-up.	Like ordering food and waiting forever. Follow up yourself, or it may never come.
Sample: "Sure. Please let them know [Name] from One Wealth Map called. When is a good time for me to try again?"			
17	"Just leave a voicemail."	Use the playbook voicemail. Under 20 seconds.	Like a text vs. a long letter. People finish short messages. Say your number slowly, twice.
Sample: "Hi [Owner], this is [Name] with One Wealth Map, calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. Please call me back at [number]. Again, that's [number]."			
18	"We get calls like this all the time."	Show respect. Keep the ask tiny.	Like asking a busy cashier for one quick thing. "Two minutes" is easy to say yes to.
Sample: "I understand, and I'll keep it short. When is the best time to reach [Owner] for two minutes?"			

D When the gatekeeper decides

Stay polite and let the owner make the decision.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
19	"They're not interested." (for the owner)	Probe. Find out what led to this answer, without sounding confrontational.	Like a helper saying "Ma'am doesn't want it." Ma'am never saw it.
Sample: "I understand. May I ask what makes you say that? I want to be sure I'm not taking up anyone's time."			
20	"I handle these decisions."	Find out kindly if they're an owner or staff.	Like a barangay captain's secretary. They schedule, but only the captain signs.
Sample: "Thank you. Are you part of the ownership, or do you help manage operations?"			
21	"We already have an advisor." / "We don't need services."	Acknowledge their current setup. Clarify the call isn't about replacing their advisor or selling services. Redirect to the owner.	Like a tutor turned away because "the kids have a teacher." You're there for the school owner, not the kids.
Sample: "That's great that you have a setup that works. This isn't about replacing anyone or selling services. It's a business matter for [Owner]. Are they available?"			
22	"We're not hiring." / "We're not selling."	Stay calm. Don't explain. Ask for the right person.	Like a family selling their house. They don't tell the helpers first. Owner plans can be private, even from staff.
Sample: "Understood. It's a business matter for [Owner]. When is a good time to reach them?"			
23	"Talk to our operations manager."	Be polite. See if they can help you reach the owner.	Like being sent to a different window. They may not decide, but they may walk you to the right door.
Sample: "Thank you. Could they help me reach [Owner], or is there a better time to call [Owner] directly?"			

E Rules and restrictions

Follow their rules, then ask for another way to reach the owner.

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
24	"No unsolicited calls. Remove us."	Exit politely. Mark Do Not Call in GHL.	Like a "No Solicitors" sign. Respecting it protects the company's reputation.
Sample: "Of course. I'll make sure your number is removed. Thank you for your time."			
25	"Calls are recorded. They can't discuss this here."	Respect it. Ask for an email or a better number.	Like a bank full of CCTV. You don't argue with the rules. You ask to talk somewhere better.
Sample: "I understand. Is there a better number or email for [Owner]?"			

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
26	"Compliance has to approve this."	Learn their process.	Like getting a permit. Go to the right window and things move faster.
Sample: "That makes sense. Who should I send information to for review?"			
27	"Our broker-dealer doesn't allow these calls."	Stay respectful. Never comment on their agreements.	Like someone's work contract. You're not their lawyer. That's for the principals.
Sample: "Understood, I respect that. Is there another way [Owner] prefers to be contacted?"			

F Phone systems and wrong contacts

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
28	Phone menu (IVR)	Reach a real person. Directory first, then "new clients."	Like a mall directory. Look up the store instead of walking every floor. Note what worked in GHL.
Tip: Try the directory and search the owner's last name. If there's none, choose "new clients."			
29	"No one here by that name."	Ask who owns the firm now. Update GHL.	Like an old address on a package. Fix it, or the next delivery fails too.
Sample: "I may have outdated information. Who owns the firm now?"			
30	"They retired / left the firm."	Find the new owner. Update GHL.	Like a restaurant with a new owner. New leadership often means new plans.
Sample: "Thank you for letting me know. Who leads the firm now?"			
31	"They passed away."	Offer condolences and end the call. Note it in GHL.	Like visiting during a wake. You show respect and leave. Never pitch.
Sample: "I'm very sorry to hear that. Thank you for telling me, and I apologize for the call."			

G Other situations

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
32	A chatty, friendly gatekeeper	Build rapport. Learn the owner's schedule.	Like the friendly tita at the sari-sari store who tells you when the owner drops by.
Sample: "Thanks so much, [Gatekeeper]! When is usually the best time to catch [Owner]?"			
33	A rude gatekeeper, or they hang up	Stay professional. Try another day.	Like a grumpy jeepney driver. Their bad day, not yours.
Sample: "Thank you for your time." Then log it and try again another day.			

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
34	"Can you hold?" (long hold)	Keep the call. Get ready while waiting.	Like a bank line. Fill out your form while waiting so you're ready when called.
Sample: "Sure, I'll hold. Thank you." If the hold is long: "I don't want to keep you. When is a better time to call?"			
35	Third callback, same gatekeeper	Use their name. Mention the last call.	Like the guard who now greets you by name. Being polite and consistent builds familiarity.
Sample: "Hi [Gatekeeper], it's [Name] from One Wealth Map again. Is [Owner] available today?"			
36	You get cut off mid-sentence	Finish your point calmly, then redirect.	Like a jeepney stopping short of your stop. You still say "para po" and get off where you need to.
Sample: "Sorry, just to finish: it's a business matter for [Owner]. Are they available?"			
37	The owner answers directly	Switch to owner mode right away.	Like the boss walking past you in the lobby. Don't freeze. Greet them and introduce yourself.
Sample: "Hi [Owner], this is [Name] with One Wealth Map. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. Do you have two minutes?"			

H When you reach the owner

If the owner is still on the line, you still have a chance to ask a question.



#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
38	"I'm good." / "We're doing well."	Acknowledge with real energy. Then ask one question about what's next.	Like a healthy person and insurance. Doing well today is a good time to think about later.
Sample: "That's great to hear! When you picture the practice five years from now, are you still running it, handing it off, or already out?"			
39	"I'm busy."	Respect it. Ask for a few minutes now, or set a time.	Like an elevator ride. You get one floor's worth of time. Keep it brief and get to the point.
Sample: "Sounds like I caught you at a busy time. Do you have two minutes now, or is later today better?"			
40	"Just send me information."	Treat it as a semi-win. Try one question first, then send.	Like flyers in your own inbox. Not all of them get read. Sometimes "send info" is a polite way to end the call.
Sample: "Happy to send it. So I send the right information, can I ask one quick question first?"			

#	Situation	Goal	Why it works
41	"Not interested" right after your intro	Ask what they mean, or ask one future question.	Like rejecting a package before opening it. They may not know yet what the call is about.
Sample: "I understand. May I ask what you mean? Is it the timing, or something else?"			
42	"What is this about?" from the owner	Clear purpose in one line, then a question.	Like a doctor explaining before an exam. People relax when they know why you're there.
Sample: "We're a multi-family office. Our founder, Ken Himmler, is reaching out to a small number of firm owners about what's next for their practice. Are you the owner, or part of a larger team?"			
43	"Never heard of you." / "You're small."	Agree, then build up the founder with approved facts.	Like a new restaurant by an experienced chef. People try it because of the chef's background.
Sample: "That's fair. We're at around \$300 million and growing about 40% a year, and our founder has built and sold a few firms. That's why he likes talking owner to owner."			
44	They say yes but "I'll book it later."	Offer two specific times now.	Like "let's hang out sometime." Without a date, it is easy to forget.
Sample: "Let's find a time now so it's on your calendar. Would Tuesday at 10 or Thursday at 2 work better?"			

Remember

Acknowledge first. Say it warmly so it sounds sincere. **End with a question**, so the conversation keeps going.

PRACTICE Write your own lines

Write how you would say each one. Then practice saying them out loud.

Moment	My words
My opening to a gatekeeper	
"What's this regarding?"	
"Is this a sales call?"	
"They're not available."	
Owner: "I'm good."	
My ask for the meeting	

CHECKLIST**Before you hang up**

- ☐ Did I use first names?
- ☐ Was my reason one sentence?
- ☐ Did I avoid "opportunity" and pitch words?
- ☐ Did I end with a question?

- ☐ Did everything I say stay true?
- ☐ Did I leave with a time, line or email?
- ☐ Did I say please and thank you?
- ☐ Did I log it in GHL?

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